TikTok API Verification

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TikTok API Verification Guide

Date: February 8, 2026 **Platform:** TikTok for Developers **Portal:** https://developers.tiktok.com/

📋 Overview

This guide describes the complete process to obtain API access for TikTok's developer platform, including app registration, permissions request, and audit process.

🎯 What You Need

For Developer Account:

- ✅ TikTok account (personal or business)
- ✅ Valid email address for verification
- ✅ Business details (name, website, description)

For App Registration:

- ✅ **Mobile app:** Link to App Store and/or Google Play Store
- ✅ **Web app:** Valid redirect URI (HTTPS)
- ✅ Working prototype of your application
- ✅ Clear use case description per permission

📝 Step 1: Create Developer Account

Process

1. **Go to TikTok for Developers**
   - URL: https://developers.tiktok.com/
   - Click “Register” or “Get Started”
2. **Select Account Type**
   - **Individual:** For personal projects/hobby apps
   - **Organization:** For companies and commercial apps
3. **Fill Developer Profile**
   - Email
   - Name
   - Website
   - Description
4. **Confirm Email**
   - Check inbox (and spam folder)
   - Click verification link
   - Account is now active

🚀 Step 2: Register App

Process

1. **Go to “Manage Apps”**

   - Log in to developer portal
   - Click “Create an app”

2. **Fill App Details**

   Basic Information:

- **App name:** Name of your application
- **App description:** What does your app do?

App Type:

- **Web App:**
  - Fill in redirect URI
  - Must be HTTPS
  - Example: `https://your-app.com/auth/tiktok/callback`
- **Mobile App (iOS):**
  - App Store URL (app must be published)
  - Bundle ID
  - iOS Universal Link
- **Mobile App (Android):**
  - Google Play Store URL (app must be published)
  - Package name
  - SHA-256 fingerprint

3. **Submit App Info**

   - Review all details
   - Click "Create app"
   - You'll receive Client Key and Client Secret (store securely!)

⚠️ IMPORTANT: Mobile App Requirements

For iOS Apps:

- ✅ App **MUST** be in Apple App Store
- ✅ Not in beta/TestFlight - fully published
- ✅ Publicly available (no private/enterprise apps)

For Android Apps:

- ✅ App **MUST** be in Google Play Store
- ✅ Not in internal/closed testing - fully published
- ✅ Publicly available

For Web Apps:

- ✅ Valid redirect URI with HTTPS
- ✅ Website must be accessible
- ✅ Privacy policy publicly available

🔑 Step 3: Request API Permissions

TikTok follows **minimum permissions principle**: request ONLY what you truly need.

Available API Products

1️⃣ Login Kit

- Basic user info
- Profile picture and username

Scopes: - `user.info.basic`

2️⃣ Content Posting API

- Post videos on behalf of user
- Schedule videos
- Add captions and hashtags

Scopes: - `video.publish` - `video.list`

3️⃣ Data API (Analytics)

- Video statistics
- Account analytics
- Engagement metrics

Scopes: - `video.insights` - `user.insights`

📤 Step 4: Permission Request Submission

Process

1. **Go to App Dashboard**
   - Select your app
   - Click "Add products"
2. **Select API Products**
   - Choose desired products
   - For each product: select specific scopes
3. **For Each Permission: Detailed Use Case**

   Describe EXACTLY:

   - What does your app do?
   - Why do you need this permission?
   - How does this improve user experience?
   - Which feature uses this permission?
4. **Submit for Review**
   - **Wait time: 5-14 days**

🔍 Step 5: Audit Process (For Production)

To post public content, you must go through TikTok's audit process.

When to Request Audit?

✅ **Ready for audit when:** - Development testing is complete - All features work flawlessly - Security audit is done - Privacy policy is complete - Ready for production launch

Audit Process

1. **Prepare Documentation**
   - Complete feature documentation
   - Screenshots of all features
   - Video demo (required, max 15 minutes)
   - Security documentation
2. **Submit Audit Request**
   - **Timeline:** 7-14 days
3. **After Approval**
   - ✅ Production mode active
   - ✅ Content is publicly visible
   - ✅ Full API access
   - ✅ Ready for launch

⏱️ Complete Timeline

Phase	Duration
Developer Account	5-10 min
App Registration	10-20 min
Permission Request	5-14 days
Development Testing	2-4 weeks
Audit Submission	7-14 days
Total	**4-8 weeks**

📊 Rate Limits

API Rate Limits (Production)

Endpoint Type	Limit
Video Upload	10 per day per user
Video List	100 calls per day
User Info	1000 calls per day
Analytics	500 calls per day

🚨 Common Mistakes

❌ Mistake 1: App Not in App Store

Problem: App submission without public app store listing **Solution:** Publish first in App Store/Play Store, then request TikTok API

❌ Mistake 2: Too Broad Permissions

Problem: "We want everything for future features" **Solution:** Request ONLY permissions you need NOW, expand later

❌ Mistake 3: Vague Use Case

Problem: "We're making a social media app" **Solution:** Be specific: which feature, why this permission, how it helps users?

✅ Complete Checklist

Before Starting:

- [ ] TikTok developer account created
- [ ] Email verified
- [ ] Business details complete

App Registration:

- [ ] App name chosen (unique, no "TikTok")
- [ ] App description written (>50 chars)
- [ ] **Mobile:** App published in App Store/Play Store
- [ ] **Web:** Redirect URI configured (HTTPS)
- [ ] Client Key and Secret securely stored

Permissions:

- [ ] Minimum permissions selected
- [ ] Use case per permission written
- [ ] Privacy policy publicly available

Development:

- [ ] OAuth flow tested
- [ ] API calls tested
- [ ] Error handling robust
- [ ] Rate limiting implemented

Audit (Production):

- [ ] Minimum 2 weeks development testing
- [ ] All bugs fixed
- [ ] Complete documentation prepared
- [ ] Video demo created (max 15min)
- [ ] Audit requested

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